INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Marketing

MARKETING MANAGEMENT TEAM DECISION MAKING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Describe marketing functions and related activities.
2. Describe connections between company actions and results (e.g., influencing consumer buying behavior, gaining market share, etc.).
3. Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior.
4. Explain the concept of marketing strategies.
5. Identify ways to track marketing-communications activities.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the roles of the marketing director and the marketing analyst for LUMEN FITNESS, a chain of 30 boutique fitness studios offering cycling, strength and yoga classes. The chief executive officer (judge) is planning to cut the marketing budget and wants your team to explain what marketing actually does for the business before a final decision is made.

LUMEN FITNESS charges $159 a month for unlimited classes. Membership grew quickly for five years but has been flat at about 18,000 members for the past 12 months. New low-cost gyms charging $25 a month have opened near 11 LUMEN studios, and many people now work out at home with fitness apps. About 4% of members cancel each month, mostly in their first 90 days.

LUMEN spends $2.4 million a year on marketing. The chief executive officer (judge) sees most of that as social media ads and believes it isn't working. The CEO plans to cut the budget by 40% and use the savings to lower membership prices. The marketing team knows its work goes well beyond ads. It sets class prices and packages, researches what members want, chooses studio locations and handles the referral program, which brings in 30% of new members. But the team has never shown the CEO clear results for any of that work.

The chief executive officer (judge) will make a decision on the budget at the end of the month. Specifically, the chief executive officer (judge) wants your team to:

- Describe the marketing functions LUMEN FITNESS performs and how each one affects the business
- Explain why people choose, stay with or leave a fitness studio
- Recommend a marketing strategy to grow membership and reduce cancellations
- Explain how LUMEN can track its marketing activities to prove they lead to results

You will present your recommendations to the chief executive officer (judge) in a meeting to take place in the chief executive officer's (judge's) office. The chief executive officer (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your recommendations and have answered the chief executive officer's (judge's) questions, the chief executive officer (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Why would someone pay $159 a month when a gym down the street costs $25?
2. If we cut the marketing budget by 40%, what results would you expect to change first?

Rate the participants' ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Describe marketing functions and related activities.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Describe connections between company actions and results (e.g., influencing consumer buying behavior, gaining market share, etc.).	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Explain the concept of marketing strategies.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Identify ways to track marketing-communications activities.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	